Union Conference Record

"Be strong all ye people, saith the Lord, and work; for I am with you."

Vol. 11. No. 49. SYDNEY, MONDAY, DECEMBER 9, 1907. Registered at the General Post Office, Sydney, for transmission by Post as a Newspaper

NOT NOW.

The path of duty I clearly trace,
I stand with conscience face to face,
And all her pleas allow:
Calling and crying the while for grace,—
"Some other time, and some other place;
Oh, not to-day; not now!"

I know 'tis a demon boding ill,
I know I have power to do if I will,
And I put my hand to the plough;
I have fair sweet seeds in my barn, and lo!
When all the furrows are ready to sow,
The voice says "Oh, not now!"

My peace I sell at the price of woe;
In heart and in spirit I suffer so,
The anguish wrings my brow;
But still I linger and cry for grace,—
"Some other time, and some other place;
Oh, not to-day; not now!"

I talk to my stubborn heart and say,
"The work I must do I will do to-day;
I will make to the Lord a vow;
And I will not rest and I will not sleep
Till the vow I have vowed I rise and keep;"
And the demon cries, "Not now!"

And so the days and the years go by,
And so I register lie upon lie,
And break with heaven my vow;
For when I would boldly take my stand,
This terrible demon stays my hand,—
"Oh, not to-day; not now!"

—*Selected.*

Depending on Christ.

LET not those connected with the Master's service look to men of large ability to do their work for them. God stands behind the one who does his best. Let the workers rely on divine power, and God will impress the hearts of those for whom they labor. Great good may be accomplished by the sincere, humble worker, who realizes that success does not depend on appearances, but on the One who has given him his commission.

The reason that the number of workers is so much smaller than it should be, is that men are looking at their supposed weakness, and putting their trust in those whose appearance and capabilities will, they suppose, bring success. Thus spiritual consumption is brought into the church, and souls are dying because the spiritual life-blood is poisoned. Men have depended on men till they are strengthless.

God desires a different mould placed on His work. Let men go forth to labor, trusting in the Lord, and He will go with them, convicting and converting souls. One worker may be a ready speaker, another a ready writer; another may have the gift of sincere, earnest, fervent prayer, another the gift of singing. Another may have special power to explain the Word of God with clearness. And each gift is to become a power for God because He coöperates with the worker. To one God gives the word of wisdom, to another knowledge, to another faith. But all are to work under the same head. The diversity of gifts leads to a diversity of operations, "but it is the same God which worketh all in all."

Let no man despise the supposed lesser gifts. Let all go to work. Let no one fold his hands in unbelief because he thinks that he can do no mighty work. Cease looking at self. Look to your Leader. In meekness, sincerity, and love do what you can. Do your best in faith, and out of weakness you shall be made strong. God will certainly bless whole-hearted workers.

The world is enshrouded in the darkness of error. Satan and his angels are urging on their warfare against the truth. We must have help. But the help we need will not come from human beings. We must look to Him who has said, "All power is given unto Me in heaven and in earth. Go ye therefore, and teach all nations, baptizing them in the name of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Ghost: teaching them to observe all things whatsoever I have commanded you." "These signs shall follow them that believe: In My name shall they cast out devils; they shall speak with new tongues; they shall take up serpents; and if they drink any deadly thing, it shall not hurt them; they shall lay hands on the sick, and they shall recover." "Lo, I am with you alway, even unto the end of the world."

Claim this promise, instead of going to men for help. There stands among you the Mighty Counselor of the ages, inviting you to place your confidence in Him. Shall we turn from Him to uncertain human beings, who are as wholly dependent on God as we ourselves are? Have we not fallen far below our privileges? Have we not been guilty of expecting so little that we have not asked for what God is longing to give?

In a variety of figures, matters have been presented to me regarding the church-members who are dwarfed in spirituality because they do not look to Jesus, their ever-present help in time of trouble. I see men bearing a heavy burden of responsibility, but they are not gaining the strength of hope and courage by exercising faith in God. The promise is, "Ask, and it shall be given you; seek, and ye shall find; knock, and it shall be opened unto you." But when in trouble, they think that they must go to earthly friends, telling them their troubles, and begging for help. Under trying circumstances, unbelief comes in, and the way seems dark. And all the time Jesus, the great Burden-Bearer, stands beside them, saying, Come unto Me, and I will give you the rest for which you are longing. Why do we turn from Him?

My brethren and sisters, show more confidence in Jesus. Turn not from the waters of Lebanon to seek refreshing at broken cisterns, which can hold no water. Have faith in

God. Praise Him with heart and voice. God demands heart and life service. Reach higher and still higher, and catch divine rays from Him who is light and peace and joy and gladness. Do not wait for some one more ready of speech, but do what you can in the meekness of the great Master, who gave His life for you, that His joy might remain in you, and that your joy might be full.

There are many souls in the darkness of error. There is abundant work for all who know the truth. Approach the people in a persuasive, kindly manner, full of sympathy and love. Christ is ever passing by, with grace and power that will enable you to present the gospel of salvation. Reach out after the souls ready to perish. Call the attention of the people to the Lamb of God, who takes away the sin of the world.

No human words can express the preciousness of the ministration of the Word and the Holy Spirit. No human tongue can portray to the finite mind the value of receiving by living faith the blessing that is given as Jesus of Nazareth passeth by. Many have a deep sense of need,—a need that earthly riches or pleasure can not supply; but they know not how to obtain that for which they are longing.

The gospel of Christ is from beginning to end a gospel of saving grace. It is a distinctive and controlling idea. It will be a help to the needy, light for eyes that are blind, and a guide to the souls seeking for the sure foundation. Full and everlasting salvation is within the reach of every soul. Christ is waiting and longing to speak pardon, and to impart the freely offered grace. He is watching and waiting, saying, as He said to the blind man at the gate of Jericho, What wilt thou that I should do unto thee? I will take away your sins, and wash you in My blood.

In the highways and byways of life there are souls to be saved. The blind are groping in darkness. Give them the light, and God will bless your efforts.

Christ is our Leader. He presents before His soldiers the plan of the battle. He points out the imminent peril of the conflict, and enjoins every one to count the cost. As He shows us the preparation that we must make for the battle, He assures us that we shall have divine assistance. In our human weakness, we shall be enabled to do the deeds of Omnipotence.

Christ takes His soldiers to an eminence, and shows them the vast confederacy arrayed against them. He reminds them that they are not warring against flesh and blood, but against principalities and powers, against the rulers of the darkness of this world, against spiritual wickedness in high places. He reminds them that they are fighting for eternal life. The heavenly universe are marshaled for the conflict, with Christ, the Commander of the forces of heaven, at their head. Infirmities compass humanity, but in the strength that Christ gives, we may be more than conquerors. "Be of good cheer," He declares; "I have overcome the world."

MRS. E. G. WHITE.

"A heart that ever overflows
With love for all its kind,
And pitying weak humanity,
To errors oft is blind;
A hand that in the cause of right
Is lifted, not for greed—
These two combined, with a clear head,
Make just the men we need."

Religious Liberty.

Studies in Liberty.

Pagan Conception of Church and State.

"And ye were now turned, and had done right in My sight, in proclaiming liberty every man to his neighbour." Jer. 34: 15.

"AND He said unto them, The kings of the Gentiles exercise lordship over them; and they that exercise authority upon them are called benefactors." "And say ye, Save us, O God of our salvation, and gather us together, and deliver us from the heathen, that we may give thanks to Thy holy name, and glory in Thy praise."

The two most celebrated associations in history have been the church and the state. With the true and enlightened followers of Christ neither one was to dominate the other, but both were to accomplish the definite mission for which they were ordained. With apostate Christianity the church dominated the state. The pagan idea was that the State was supreme in civil and religious matters, and its mission was to rule in things civil and things divine. Their idea is seen in all its phases in the Roman Empire. The State took precedence of everything. As nations were conquered, one by one, their religion and gods were tolerated by the State till the whole life of the kingdom, "whether of the philosopher who despised, or the vulgar who were indifferent to, the essential part of religion, was pervaded by the spirit of polytheism. It met him in every form, in every act and function of every day's business; not merely in the graver offices of the State, in the civil and military acts of public men; in the senate which commenced its deliberations with sacrifice; in the camp, the centre of which was a consecrated temple. The pagan's domestic hearth was guarded by the Penates, or by the ancestral gods of his family or tribe."—*Milman, History of Christianity, bk. 2, chap. 3, par. 2.*

Although the gods worshipped in the Roman Empire were legion, all had to be recognized by law, and no proselytizing, outside the worshipper's own domain, was permitted; especially was this true among Roman citizens. The law read, "Let no one have separate gods, or new gods; and let no one privately worship even foreign gods, unless they have been received by public authority." —*Cicero.*

It will be readily understood how Christianity came in conflict with the Roman Empire. The message of salvation was to be preached in all the world for a witness to all men. It could not be nationalized by any government on earth. It was to teach all men that God was supreme, and that in Jesus Christ was to be found the highest good for all men. In Rome "The idea of the State was the highest idea of ethics; and within that was included all actual realization of the highest good; hence the development of all other good pertaining to humanity, was made dependent on this."—*Neander, History of the Christian Religion and Church, Vol. 1, pt. 1, sec. 1, div. 3, par. 1.*

This exaltation of the State was in matters of religion as well as in civil affairs. All the people and their gods were servants of the State, and hence all religion was only the servant of the State and subordinate to it. This idea was natural to the human reason; for had not Rome conquered all nations and their gods? and for this reason must be greater? And above all, every religion was held subordinate to that of Rome, and though "all forms of religion

might come to Rome and take their places in the pantheon, they must come as the servants of the State."

When the Cæsars stood at the head of the Roman Empire, they were the embodiment of the State, and represented its dignity, power, magesty, and divinity. When Jesus told the people to render tribute to Cæsar but their *worship* to *God alone*, the glory of the pagan power was gone, and civil government stood as a servant instead of a deity. It must be obeyed as a servant, but *only* in its appointed sphere. This doctrine by right forever separated every Christian from pagan domination, and declared the supremacy of the individual conscience in matters of religion. Jesus taught the right of every man to worship according to his own choice, but Rome declared the duty of every man to worship according to the dictates of the State. Christ taught the supremacy of God, but Rome insisted on the supremacy of the State. Christianity inspired men with the idea of individual responsibility to God, while Rome arrogated all responsibility to the State. Christ taught that to fear God and keep His commandments is the whole duty of man, but Rome taught that a man's duty is summed up in obedience to the State.

Games, sacred days, wedding festivities, and, in fact, almost all things that were done "were an essential part of the cheerful devotion of the pagans." The followers of Christ could take no part in any of these services in which honor was paid to the gods, and this subjected them to suspicion and hatred.

The character of the imperial government is well expressed in Maecena's advice to Augustus,—"Worship the gods in all respects according to the laws of your country, and compel all others to do the same; but hate and punish those who would introduce anything whatever, alien to our customs in this particular; not only for the sake of the gods, because whoever despises them is incapable of reverence for anything else; but because such persons, by introducing new divinities, mislead many to adopt also foreign laws."—*Neander, History of the Christian Religion and Church, Vol. 1, sec. 1, pt. 1, div. 3, par. 2.*

When the Christians followed the instruction of their Master to worship according to the dictates of their own conscience, they apparently defied all the Roman laws on the question of religion. The Christian doctrine declared all the gods of the empire to be no gods at all, and their worship to be idolatry. When calamities came to any part of the empire, the Christians were blamed, for they did "not worship the gods." When rain did not fall in season, or if there were floods, they were blamed because they did not worship according to State regulation. For earthquakes, famines, pestilences, and misfortunes of all kinds they were likewise blamed, and most inhumanly tortured. Who could ever wish for the return of the time when the State would predominate in religious matters! Who does not bow at the martyr's tomb, and bless him for the dearly purchased liberty of conscience that we now enjoy! Who is there so base that would sanction the union of religion with the State!

Questions.

1. What is the pagan idea of rulership? Mark 10: 42, 43; Dan. 3: 2-6, 12, 13; 6: 7.

2. When pagan rulers are converted, what is their idea of rulership? Dan. 4: 33-37.

3. Who is the author of the pagan plan? Isa. 14: 13, 14; Ezek. 28: 19; Gen. 10: 8-11; Rev. 13: 2, 4.

4. How do the heathen regard their gods, or objects of worship? Acts 19: 27, 28; 1 Kings 18: 26-28; Jer. 32: 35.

5. What principle governs them in the selection of the gods they worship? Rom. 1: 18-25; 2 Kings 17: 33-41; Dan. 3: 29; 2 Chron. 32: 10-19. Selfishness and fear.

6. Why are the pagan rulers determined that all shall worship the gods? 1 Kings 19: 2; 20: 10, 23; 2 Chron. 28: 23.

7. When gods are worshipped because they would bring calamities if they were not revered, what character will that develop in the worshippers? Ps. 135: 15-18.

8. In pagan nations what powers are supposed to reside in the rulers? Isa. 14: 13; Acts 12: 21-23.

9. How is this theory illustrated in the life of Pharoah? Ex. 5: 2.

10. How is this same idea illustrated in the lives of other rulers? Dan. 6: 7; Isa. 37: 10-13.

11. How, even among professed Christian rulers, is this evil perpetuated? See Czar of Russia, Pope of Rome and others. The idea of the divine right of kings and rulers is constantly gaining ground.

W. A. HENNIG.

Our Mission Field.

WHO WILL GO?

Through the doors that open stand
Who will go?
Calls invite on every hand;
Who will go?
You whom Christ from sin has freed,
Hear the Lord of glory plead
For the lands that lie in need:
Who will go?

Soul, does Jesus speak to you?
Will you go?
Has He work for you to do?
Who will go?
He has borne the cross before;
He will keep the crown in store:
Enter, then, the open door.
Will you go?

—*Selected.*

Philippine Mission.

ON the afternoon of October 5 occurred an event in Manila which for pageantry and pomp has not been surpassed here, it is said, for the past 300 years. The occasion was the crowning of the patron saint of the Philippines, Nuestra Señora Del Rosario (Our Lady of the Rosary). On a large open space near the church of Santo Domingo, a platform was erected, on which the ceremonies were carried out. The arches of this platform were gaily decorated with flowers and flags. The stars and stripes, the emblem of civil and religious liberty, and the Papal flag were chiefly in evidence. In the centre of the platform was a raised stand with steps leading up from either side. Seated on the platform were many dignitaries, both civil and ecclesiastical. In solemn procession from the near-by church the image that was to be crowned was carried, followed by the Papal delegate, Mgr. Agius, and a number of visiting prelates. The image was backed up to the stand, and Mgr. Agius mounted the steps from one side, and General Jas. F. Smith, the American governor-general of the Philippines, from the other. When all was in readiness, the governor-general handed the Papal delegate a small crown which was, after making the sign of the cross, placed on the head of the image of the child held in the arms of the virgin, and then a larger crown which was in the same manner placed upon the head of the image of the virgin. Both crowns were screwed to the wooden heads

of these images to keep them in place, while the blind devotees of such abject idolatry cheered heartily. A Protestant standing near me exclaimed, "Great is Diana of the Ephesians," while through my own mind was passing the scene of Israel worshipping the golden calf.

We were astonished to see the governor-general and other men who should have known better, taking part in the idolatrous work of crowning wooden images. To the ignorant Filipinos this could mean nothing else than a representative of the Government taking an official part, and the most painful impression left on the mind was the effect this scene had on the thousands of Filipinos who witnessed it. To the Filipino such a spectacular display is religion. There is nothing deeper, no vital experience that takes hold on his entire life. He simply bows down and worships the idol, and goes away to gamble in the booths erected around the church during the fiesta, or to commit any sin that a depraved nature suggests. Little indeed do they know about Christ and His work of love and mercy, but every child can relate the wonderful miracles ascribed to these images.

Gold and jewels to the value of about $25,000 were used in making the crowns for this occasion. This material was obtained in exactly the same manner as the gold for making the golden calf when Israel forgot God and turned to idols.

Let no one think that Rome is any different to-day than she was during the Dark Ages. "*Semper Idem*" ("Always the same") is her proud boast. The Catholic Church is stronger in the Philippines to-day than she has been for a long time, notwithstanding opposing elements. She is using every means to strengthen her forces.

Recently a commission was appointed to assess the amount of damages done to church property during the war here. The United States Government is to pay a good price for all buildings damaged or destroyed. It is evident that these claims are greatly overdrawn, but that they will be paid, is evident as a matter of political expediency. The Catholic vote is a very potent factor in deciding elections, and it must be secured even at the price of paying for buildings that some claim the friars themselves burned. Thus rulers and statesmen are going to Canossa, and of their weakness Rome adds to her own strength.

May God lay the burden on many hearts for giving the last saving message to these needy people, is our earnest prayer.

J. L. McElhany.

Manila, P. I.

Padang, Sumatra.

Time is passing rapidly, and the work seems to move slowly. We have striven to bring various plans of operation to an issue, yet have apparently failed to meet our expectations. Still our courage and health, which have frequently threatened to give way, have been renewed constantly, and we are thankful for this evidence of the Lord's merciful hand which has been over us all the way.

While engaged in keeping bright, and letting our own "lights shine" to resist the in-pressing darkness all around us, the vail was lifted a moment this week, enabling us to see the *stir* created in the enemy's camp, revealed through a two-column article by the editor of the *Sumatra Bade* dealing with the "modernized phase of religion," which, it says, "is assuming large proportions, and a threatening attitude toward the established standard church (the Roman Catholic) the world over."

The special point of import to us, as touching our work, is the reference made to the "identification" of this so-called "modernism," which is exerting its world-wide influence against "*the church and order*," "through the free circulation of literature filled with this influence."

The blow thus aimed at the foundation of our work here, will be readily seen, since two-thirds of the Dutch-Eurasian population are Roman Catholics, and the rest seem to care little one way or the other. Nevertheless we see in it a source of encouragement which fills us with new vigor to continue the work of placing our reading matter (which evidently has in it, that which fills the enemy with alarm) into the hands of the people, who thus far have accepted it readily.

The needful lesson of patience is being taught us in many ways, one of which we experienced when on the receipt of a cablegram from the Union Conference authorizing us to secure the present occupied Mission site, the agent in charge of the said property announced the impossibility of his proceeding with the transaction at present, having recently received word from Europe, where the owners (a company) reside, that a court case was pending at home concerning these properties. Thus we are held in further suspense in this matter for another two or three months, but are comforted with the assurance "that all things work together for good to them that love God."

A heavy flood visited Padang recently, it being regarded as a record within the last fifty years. The whole of the Chinese and the Malay quarters, and business places were submerged, the depth of water ranging from three to six feet in the main streets. The damage done was very extensive, a number of buildings collapsing entirely; while one street was transformed into a creek.

The Chinese attending our meetings, which we still hold in our house, appear to be unstable in their interests. They attend a while regularly and then stay away as long, after which some return, fresh ones taking the places of others, and so on. They seem unfathomable. Five have taken hold to help us to sell the Malay tracts on the "Second Advent," but have had little success as yet, the Mohammedan spirit manifesting itself through stubborn refusals of accepting them on any condition.

White-robed priests, heading a procession composed of dancing "god-bearers," who exchange in bearing along a glittering tinsel ornamentation through the streets, accompanied by clanking cymbals almost every night, now design in this manner to keep alive the interest in this mode of worship; and so hold off the influence of any "intruder" on that domain.

Thus we see efforts made in various ways to oppose the advancing light of the third angel's message. But we are glad to see the circle of our acquaintances constantly widening, and look toward the ultimate fulfillment of the promise of the Lord that our labor shall not be in vain; for His word shall not return unto Him void. Upon this is based our confidence and hope, and by His grace we will continue steadfast.

G. A. Wantzlick.

The fruit of success is greater opportunity.—*Selected.*

OUR FIELD WORK.

The Tasmanian Conference.

THE annual conference for Tasmania was held at Hobart, November 14-24. All the meetings were held in the church building in Warwick Street. Our brethren who attended, were accommodated in homes of our brethren and sisters, or in places elsewhere provided.

Most of the delegates took their meals other than breakfast, at the Sanitarium Cafe. Here good, wholesome meals are served in a very up-to-date little cafe, which is managed by Mrs. Lee-Ulrick.

The attendance at the conference was not large. Various causes, including sickness, seemed to conspire to keep some who were expected, away. Still we had a good meeting, and those present were blessed. The church was well filled in the evenings, and especially so upon the Sabbaths.

Our meetings upon the two Sabbaths were a blessing to many. The Spirit of God worked upon hearts, and upon the first Sabbath quite a number of young people came forward to seek the Lord. On the second Sabbath a call for reconsecration was responded to by a still larger number than the Sabbath before. We trust the vows made before God will be lasting.

The various branches of our work were presented to our people. Pastor Hennig gave some studies on Religious Liberty; Pastor Hoopes presented the Educational Question, and spoke on the young people's work; Brother Johanson and others spoke on the importance of our Missionary Campaign; and our work in the island fields came in for a share of consideration. The young people in Tasmania are supporting two native workers in Fiji, which shows their interest in this line of missionary effort.

The business connected with the Tasmanian Conference passed off harmoniously. Pastor Finster was elected president in place of Pastor Pallant, who is now leaving for his new field of labor.

Our brethren decided to finish up their work on "Christ's Object Lessons," and in a practical way showed their determination to do so at once by taking a large share of the books at this meeting. Reference was made to "Ministry of Healing" also, and it was decided to enter upon the sale of this book as soon as "Christ's Object Lessons" are sold. A number of "Ministry of Healing" were ordered by individuals.

The weather was ideal throughout the meeting. The place was ideal also. The quiet little city of Hobart, in the beautiful valley of the Derwent River, with the encircling hills and snow-capped mountains, is certainly "beautiful for situation." The climate is bright and bracing. The parks were lovely and green, the gardens gorgeous in flowers of every tint and sweetest perfume. We thought since it can be yet so lovely on this earth, what must it be when all things shall be made new!

We were glad to meet so many of our dear Tasmanian brethren. We shall take a greater interest in the island State. May God add His blessing to the work in this Conference. J. E. FULTON.

West Australia.

ON arrival in West Australia it was thought best that we should spend the time previous to Brother Finster's departure, in visiting as many of the churches and companies as was possible. Accordingly, a few days later, we took the Kalgoorlie express at 6 P. M., October 10, and at 9.30 A. M. the following morning we reached the goldfield towns, Kalgoorlie and Boulder City.

The writer was surprised to find such well-laid-out towns in the midst of the desert. The streets are all two and three chains wide, running parallel and at right angles to one another. At night they are well lighted with electricity. Both towns have good electric tramway systems. Water, which comes from the coast through iron pipes, a distance of 300 miles, is laid on to all the houses; thus the one-time water famines of this locality are a thing of the past.

It was the little company of Sabbath-keepers that most interested us. This little band has been gathered out mainly through the efforts of one of our canvassers. Nine years ago Pastor A. G. Daniells visited these towns, and returned with a burden to see them have the message. Less than two years ago a lady Bible-worker was sent to work in this field, and she has her time fully occupied, and we felt that the time had come when an experienced minister should locate there. After leaving Kalgoolie we visited the churches and companies at Quellington, York, Northam, Jurendine, Wongamine, Newcastle, Jumperding and Heidelberg. At Newcastle and vicinity, Brother W. E. Prees is at work, and the Lord is blessing the effort put forth by bringing souls into the truth.

At Heidelberg we had the pleasure of visiting our preparatory Training School for workers. We were pleased with the location. It is on the Darling Range, and has an altitude of about 1,000 feet above sea-level, and is one of the most healthful places in the West. During the year, work has been carried on in erecting and preparing buildings to carry on school work the coming year. This work has been done by several of our young people under the direction of Brother H. R. Martin, and there seems to be an excellent spirit manifested among them. We know our brethren in West Australia will take advantage of this School being among them, and encourage suitable young people in the faith to attend it, and so prepare themselves for future usefulness in the cause. The School will open February 5, 1908.

On our return to Perth, the Conference Committee met, and in conjunction with several of the workers, laid plans for the summer's work. Pastor Hilliard and wife were invited to make Kalgoorlie and vicinity their field of labor. The tent was sent to Pingelly, and with it Brethren Howie and Waldorff. Brother Prees was advised to remain at Newcastle, and Sister Dawkins will continue to labor in the goldfield towns in connection with Pastor Hilliard. It was decided to call Brother C. E. Ashcroft, elder of the Heidelberg Church, into the work, and give him charge of the Sabbath-school work, young people's work, and the Missionary Campaign effort. We want to build up these departments of our work in order that they may be telling factors in the spread of the third angel's message.

Owing to a depression in industrial circles and hence a shifting population, our tract society work has been passing through somewhat of a trying time, but there is every indication of a good harvest this year, and we expect that our book work will benefit therefrom. How-

ever, the Lord is not limited by circumstances, and rightly managed this work must succeed. Our State agent, Brother Branford, has the work at heart and carries a burden for it.

The profits on the sales of health foods are well above the running expenses, and we are hoping that our sales will increase. Brother W. Parsons has charge of this department of the work.

Our brethren and sisters in the West love the third angel's message, and appreciate the fact that it has done much for them. There is a desire on the part of almost all to have a humble part in spreading it, and our hope is that this desire may have its fruition in many souls being garnered in the great harvest of the earth. Brethren, pray for us.

A. H. PIPER.

Arcadia.

WE have previously reported in connection with the opening of the work in Arcadia and district. The conclusion of our tent effort has convinced us that men can do nothing against the truth, but for it.

From the first there was a manifest desire on the part of intelligent men and women to know the truth. To them the promise has been verified, "Ye shall know the truth, and the truth shall make you free."

Men who had not been inside a place of worship for over twenty years, are, as a result of this effort, to-day walking in the light, and bearing responsibilities in connection with the local work. Habits of a lifetime have been overcome. Sins have been confessed, and wrongs righted. God, by His Holy Spirit, has visited this dear people in power, and to Him be all the praise.

Before the camp-meeting a baptismal service was held at the Berowra Creek, an ideal spot for such a solemn and an important event. There was a large gathering both of our own people and of the people of the surrounding districts.

Pastor Starr spoke on the "Importance of Baptism" to those assembled, as they sat on the rocks and in the boats, under the shade of the large trees growing on the banks of the Berowra Creek.

Following this service twenty-three candidates prepared themselves for the watery grave. Four others, Captain Hill's family, were unable to make train connection, otherwise tey would have gone forward also. They made a noble attempt, only to be disappointed. Those present were led by the writer, two by two, till the last, down into the beautiful, clear water of this creek, and buried with their Lord in baptism and raised to walk in newness of life. Those upon the shore joined heartily in singing appropriate songs.

The occasion was very impressive, and the day one long to be remembered. No fewer than six fathers went forward, and their wives with them in four instances.

After the baptism we all sat down again under the shade trees, and partook of a most liberal supply of God's rich bounties—including a plenteous supply of choice oranges and mandarines brought fresh from the orchards.

The work in the district is under the charge of Sister Robertson as Bible-worker, and the blessing of the Lord still continues.

There are many more in the district who know the truth, but have, so far, refused to surrender. I bespeak an interest in your prayers in behalf of the work and worker of Arcadia.

F. W. PAAP.

"Provoke unto Love and Good Works."

AS WE have read the good reports in the RECORD from time to time of the missionary work being done by our various churches and isolated members, and noted the various lines of work that have been followed, with the success attending these efforts, we have thought of the words,—"Let us consider one another to provoke unto love and good works," and we have been stimulated and strengthened to press forward with renewed courage.

Therefore, knowing how we have been often helped by the reports of others we give a brief summary of the work that the Windsor Church Missionary Society has been doing during the last three months. The following has been reported by the adults and young people of this church:—

Missionary letters written ...	12
Bible-readings held	45
Visits to hospitals, ships, etc. ...	220
Papers sold	3,538
" loaned	249
" posted and given away ...	2,583
Pages of tracts sold	78
" " " loaned	5,521
" " " given away ...	2,293
Books sold	35
" loaned	73
" given away	36
Families supplied with food and clothing	13

In the recent effort which was made in circulating the Smokers' Number of the Australasian *Good Health*, it was suggested that we place some of them in the institution of the Young Men's Christian Association and in other well-known reading rooms of Melbourne. Over 200 copies of the paper were paid for by our members, and donated for this purpose, and most of them have been gladly accepted by those in charge of the institutions.

We have realized to some extent the importance of circulating our religious liberty leaflets among the people, and quite a large number have already been distributed. We know that as a church we are not doing all that it is our privilege to do in this and in other directions, and we pray that the Lord will inspire every one of us with more zeal and determination to work.

We received an encouraging letter a few days ago from a sister who is a member of the church, but is not able to attend the meetings, which shows that with a full determination to work and a firm trust in God we can sow the seeds of truth wherever we are. The letter reads as follows:—

I am sending you my report of missionary work done for September and October. I am glad to say that the Lord has helped me and given me great courage. I find the more I work the more strength I get. I never miss an opportunity to speak a word for Jesus, or hand out a paper or tract to those with whom I come in contact; and I know that if I sow in faith, the Lord will see to the increase.

You will see that the past two months I have sold 125 *Signs of the Times*, posted and given away forty-five, and have also given away seventy-seven tracts, loaned three books, given three *Good Healths*, and paid two missionary visits.

I trust that my next report will be a better one than this. I long for others to know this message, and know that the Lord will help me in giving it.

We hear from this sister regularly, and trust that her simple report will encourage others who are not able to attend our meetings, to work for those who are perishing around them. "The Lord calls upon His servants to carry His message to the people. The word of everlasting life must be given to those who are perishing in their sins. . . . To a great degree this must be accomplished by *personal labor*. We are not to wait for souls to come to us; *we must seek them out where they are*."

C. M. RULE.

Statistical Report of the Australasian Union Conference for the Year Ending June 30, 1907.

Name of Conference or Mission	Year Organized.	Area in Square Miles.	Population.	Number of Churches.	Membership of Churches.	Number of Companies.	Membership of Companies.	Number of Isolated Sabbath-Keepers.	Total Sabbath-Keepers.	Number of Sabbath-Schools.	Membership of Sabbath-Schools.	Number of Church Buildings.	Number of Ministers.	Licensed Preachers.	Bible-Workers.	Canvassers.	Total Laborers.	Laborers on Conf. Pay Roll.	Number of Church-Schools.	Number of Teachers.	Total Enrollment.	Total Tithe Receipts.	Total Offerings to Foreign Missions, except S. S. Offerings.	Total Sabbath-School Offerings.	Sabbath-School Donations to Missions.	Total Contributions for Special Work.	Total Contributions for Local Church Work.	Sales of Books and Periodicals. Retail Value.
Australasian Union	1894	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	6	2	2	...	...	12	...	...	...	£521 11 8	£119 12 3	£... ...	£... ...	£... ...	£... ...	£677 14 8
New South Wales	1895	310,700	1,473,973	22	869	9	78	50	997	38	1157	13	4	3	10	12	29	21	4	4	61	2352 13 10	453 15 9	274 13 4	226 19 0	80 15 7	111 9 11	3359 28 7
New Zealand	1889	106,259	857,339	15	396	15	87	120	603	28	579	12	3	2	4	10	19	10	2	2	28	1852 16 9	227 14 6	303 16 3	205 12 11	39 13 4	... ...	3331 18 8
N. Queensland	1904	...	...	1	28	...	...	2	30	2	40	...	1	...	1	1	4	2	...	...	...	135 7 7	26 1 3	22 16 8	19 11 3	13 11 2	3 8 9	695 15 4
Queensland ...	1899	668,497	526,366	5	237	5	23	34	294	6	244	4	1	2	1	4	10	6	...	...	...	588 18 3	78 9 7	54 11 6	43 0 11	2 6 9	7 19 1	1404 18 0
South Australia	1899	904,600	381,148	10	336	5	24	13	373	12	358	4	2	1	8	6	17	7	2	2	19	1139 3 4	112 14 2	116 11 11	91 4 5	43 10 4	28 1 10	1518 0 2
Tasmania ...	1901	26,215	178,906	6	222	1	5	46	273	10	259	6	2	2	3	7	14	7	3	4	85	860 16 1	90 15 3	69 4 4	61 16 8	29 10 2	31 8 10	1078 13 1
Victoria ...	1888	87,884	1,210,304	16	718	1	15	36	769	25	810	5	2	2	11	14	29	18	1	1	16	2232 11 10	251 12 7	274 19 8	212 18 11	... ...	224 9 2	3070 9 5
West Australia	1902	975,920	259,029	16	333	2	20	40	393	26	492	4	2	2	6	7	21	8	2	2	34	1587 3 9	57 6 5	204 6 8	174 12 7	... ...	... ...	774 11 9
Fiji	1899	8,000	121,000	10	133	...	...	5	138	19	270	5	2	...	3	...	11	11	1	1	4	79 1 4	... ...	16 19 8	16 17 0	7 10 11	... ...	5 19 3
Java	1906	50,000	32,000,000	...	...	1	8	1	9	2	9	...	1	...	1	...	2	2	...	...	...	14 6 8	... ...	5 15 7	5 11 2	... ...	2 0 0	... ...
Norfolk Island	1893	21	700	1	20	...	...	20	40	1	20	1	...	...	1	...	2	1	...	...	...	10 9 11	... ...	3 16 11	5 5 2	1 14 6	1 14 6	... ...
Philippine Is....	1906	115,026	7,635,426	...	...	1	2	...	2	1	2	...	1	...	...	1	3	1	...	...	...	23 16 3	... ...	2 4 8	1 9 10	... ...	... ...	... ...
Pitcairn... ...		6	173	1	90	...	...	...	90	1	131	1	...	...	...	...	1	1	1	1	...	43 6 1	... ...	4 13 4	4 13 4	... ...	... ...	... ...
Rarotonga ...	1894	200	13,500	1	91	1	9	...	30	3	44	1	1	...	...	...	3	2	1	1	20	31 3 9	3 3 3	4 6 7	4 6 7	10 10	2 0 0	15 9
Sumatra ...	1899	161,612	3,000,000	...	...	1	3	...	3	1	3	...	1	...	...	...	1	1	...	...	...	7 14 7	... ...	3 2 9	3 2 9	2 8 4	... ...	... ...
Singapore ...	1899	226	300,000	...	...	1	31	...	31	1	52	...	1	...	4	2	8	5	1	2	28	115 16 2	13 5 11	21 5 9	16 10 5	2 13 8	33 10 4	468 0 1
Tahiti	1892	642	12,800	4	64	1	6	1	71	9	139	3	1	...	1	...	2	1	5	1	10	51 11 10	... ...	11 4 9	11 4 9	... ...	... ...	8 18 7
Tonga	1895	374	18,000	2	11	...	...	3	14	1	25	2	1	...	1	...	4	3	1	2	59	73 13 6	17 8 0	18 5 5	16 16 9	47 8 6	17 6	4 4 3
Samoa	1895	1,701	3,600	...	...	...	6	...	6	1	7	...	...	...	1	...	...	...	...	...	...	11 19 4	7 0	4 8 8	4 8 8	2 16 9	... ...	2 16 9
Totals		3,446,182	48,028,864	109	3478	42	301	371	4160	186	4644	60	32	16	57	64	180	119	24	23	364	£11684 4 7	£1453 6 2	£1417 7 3	£1126 3 1	£279 0 7	£446 10 0	£16402 17 4

No. of Colleges and Academies.—Union Conference, 1. Number of Teachers, 10. Total Enrollment, 213.
No. of Intermediate Schools.—West Australia, 1; Fiji, 1. Number of Teachers: West Australia, 2; Fiji, 2. Total Enrollment: West Australia, 12; Fiji, 23.
Amount of Tithe Appropriated to Fields outside of Conference.—New South Wales, £117; New Zealand, £77 11s 5d; Victoria, £104.

PASTOR MCGOWAN, with Brother Codling as tent-master, opened a tent mission at Tuggerah during November.

BROTHER A. A. KAPPLER and Sister Miriam Rigby were united in marriage at the church, Launceston, Tasmania, on October 10, Pastor Pallant officiating.

ON Thursday afternoon, November 21, at the church, Hobart, Tasmania, Brother Harry Eyre was married to Sister Metcalfe by Pastor Pallant, assisted by the visiting ministerial brethren.

PASTOR F. W. PAAP is following up the interest of the Willoughby Camp-meeting, assisted by Brother Dingle and Sister Knight. The tent-meetings are now being conducted at Chatswood.

BROTHER and Sister J. A. Chaney have arrived from South Africa, and are spending a little time at the Sydney Sanitarium to recuperate their health, that has become affected by their long stay in the South African field.

THE Midsummer Issue of the *Good Health* is the handsomest and the best selling number ever issued. It contains an attractive three-color plate of a vegetarian repast. The publishers have on hand a limited supply which can be furnished at usual liberal rates.

BROTHER BRITTAIN, with Brother Bullas as tent-master, opened a tent mission at Guildford immediately following the Willoughby Camp-meeting. They report a good interest, with from forty to fifty in attendance every evening. The brethren and sisters from Parramatta are rendering valuable assistance.

BROTHER and Sister Metcalfe Hare sailed on the *Moana* on Monday, November 25, for the United States, where their two sons have preceded them to attend our School at College View, Nebraska. Brother and Sister Hare have been connected with the work at Avondale from the very beginning, and for more than three years Brother Hare has had charge of the Health Food Factory. They will be missed by those with whom they have been so long associated at Avondale.

Obituary.

GANE.—Died at the Parramatta District Hospital, November 19, 1907, from peritonitis, consequent on an operation for appendicitis, Beatrice Ethel, the youngest child of Brother and Sister Gane of Guildford, N. S. W., after a short illness of one week. Little Beatrice was the only daughter in a family of four, and was only three years and nine months old at the time of her death. All that careful nursing and medical skill could do, was done to relieve her intense suffering, which she bore with remarkable fortitude for one so young. Her parents are fully resigned to their great loss by the blessed hope that Beatrice will surely come again from the "land of the enemy," when the Saviour shall come again to make up His jewels.

We laid her to rest in the Parramatta cemetery with her little brother who had preceded her. Words of comfort were spoken at the home to the sorrowing family, and at the grave, by the writer.

W. G. BRITTAIN.

Muck-Raking.

SLANDER is a species of murder. The whisperer is altogether contemptible. We revolt from cannibalism as to the body, but many men and some women can carve a neighbor's reputation like a fowl. And yet no generation ever needed the warning more than ours. Exaggeration, harsh criticism, the charge of crime first and the proof afterward—these are the order of the day. Many a man's health has been ruined and his heart broken by a whispered slander that was afterwards found to have no basis of truth whatsoever. Judgment begins at home. We all need to remember that man-formed souls alone love evil speaking; that the ideal man can not endure to read a slander or listen to it, much less to speak one. Great is the power of the tongue. It is a little member, but it is like the rudder, which turns the whole ship and controls the voyage. Therefore avoid harsh speech and unfair criticism.—*N. D. Hillis, D.D.*

"THE experimental knowledge of true godliness found in daily consecrated service insures, the highest culture of body, mind, and soul."

Union Conference Record

PUBLISHED WEEKLY BY THE
Australasian Union Conference of Seventh Day Adventists.

"Elsnath," Burwood St., Strathfield, N. S. W., Australia.

SUBSCRIPTION RATES.

Single subscription, per year, post-paid, 4 0
Foreign Countries, per year, post-paid ($1.25) 5 0
Editor: Mrs. J. Hindson, Roland Avenue, Wahroonga, N. S. W.

Printed for the Conference by the Avondale Press, Cooranbong, N.S.W.

A Pleasant Occasion.

AFTER an exceptionally pleasant trip from Australia to Singapore, we arrived at the latter place October 25. In all the seventeen years since I began my sea life, I have never enjoyed finer weather or smoother seas. At Sourabaya, Java, we had the pleasure of meeting some of our people, but were saddened by the fact that nearly all of them had been sick with malarial fever, while Brother Teasdale's elder boy had been laid away in death. This was a terrible blow to the parents, and we all felt to deeply sympathize with them. At the time of our visit, Brother Teasdale and his family were spending a few weeks in the mountains. None of the workers save Sister Skadsheim were remaining in the city. Here we left Sister Anna Nordstrom, who will take up nursing work here. We spent nearly the whole day in this city, which was the seventeenth anniversary of the first sailing of our missionary ship to the islands. Though on account of the affliction that has visited our workers here, the work is temporarily disarranged, we have no idea that the message is to stop. All were of good courage to press on with the work.

We arrived in Singapore in time to get to the Mission, and from there to our new School site, before the beginning of the Sabbath. On the Sunday following our arrival occurred the marriage of Brother Joseph Mills and Sister Nettie Carswell, the latter having accompanied us from Brisbane to Singapore. The location of our new School is a very fine one, being on a high point just out of the city. The day was very pleasant, and most of our brethren and sisters were present at the wedding. The wedding ceremony was very simple, with no attempt at display in ornamentation. This is just as it should be on all such occasions. Pastor G. F. Jones performed the ceremony, which was followed by simple refreshments. The newly wedded couple were warmly congratulated by all the company present.

After spending a week or two in the country at the seaside, Brother and Sister Mills will take up school work at our new educational institution, which we have named the Eastern Training School. We confidently expect that these young people, whose lives have by this interesting and impressive ceremony been united for life, will devote their youthful energies to the service of the blessed Saviour.

E. H. GATES.

Singapore, October, 1907.

Experiences with "Ministry of Healing" in New South Wales.

REPORTS from the Tract Society office show that during the past three or four weeks, nearly 500 copies of the book "Ministry of Healing," have been sent out to our people. In many instances these books have been paid for in advance, at full value.

The people are now reading, loaning, and selling the book. Classes are being held at Wahroonga, North Sydney, Bondi, and Marrickville, for the study of the book, and the canvass prepared for it. The plan is to reach the other churches as soon as possible with similar meetings.

From the first we have seen evidences of the special providences of God in opening doors, and aiding in the sale of this book. We are more and more persuaded that it is the book for this time, furnished by the Spirit of God, to bless His people; and through them, to bless others.

Our first experience in selling to strangers was at the Hotel Australia, to a gentleman who had lately visited Pitcairn Island, and who wished to talk to us of our people there. Feeling that this might be our only opportunity to show him this book, we introduced it as our latest and best book. After a very brief examination, and in connection with the remark that it was beautifully printed, he said, "I will take two copies please," and paid the fifteen shillings cash. The next experience was with a physician, who is a patient at the Sanitarium. He bought a copy of both "Ministry of Healing" and "Steps to Christ," and paid twenty shillings for the two, with the request that we use the other ten shillings in any way we thought best. With this money we placed a copy in the Thomas Walker Convalescent Hospital, Parramatta River. Since this we have had varied experiences in selling single copies to individuals, including a Church of England clergyman, and the oldest minister among the Society of Friends.

A few days ago, however, we were much encouraged. We called upon one of the leading merchants of Sydney, and after telling him what some of our own people had done in taking from five to twenty copies, either to sell or give away, suggested that possibly he might use several for Christmas presents among his employees, also remarking that we felt sure of his interest in the circulation of such literature. He replied, "I am indeed, and I will take ten pounds' worth; shall I give you a cheque for it now?" to which of course we replied that we would be very pleased to receive it. As the cheque was being made out by his secretary, we assured him that his liberal purchase would be a source of great encouragement, and an inspiration in the work. The twenty-seven copies will be sent him wrapped in the specially prepared covers, which give the object for which the book is being sold.

Another gentleman living at Chatswood, is planning to use three copies as holiday presents. This convinces us that we should make prominent this point just now, as we are approaching the Christmas and New Year holidays. And is not this the time for us all to lift together for a good work? Money is paid away just a little easier now than at other times.

We would be glad to hear from all who are engaged in this work, and to have them relate any interesting experiences, especially any that would be suggestive and helpful to others. Send your experiences either to the secretary of the Tract Society, "Elsnath," Burwood, or to the undersigned. We can testify that this work brings the blessing and peace of God. G. B. STARR.

Tulip St., Chatswood.

"WELL-DIGESTED failure is the father of success."